



AI

The Dominant Industry of 2026

Insights from the TrustMRR 1,000-Startup Dataset
DAU/MAU Analysis | Standout Startup Deep-Dive

Masters Union | Session 3 | August 2026

TrustMRR Dataset: AI Leads Every Metric

1,000 bootstrapped startups across 29 categories and 65 countries — AI dominates both volume and revenue

1,000

Startups Listed

#1 AI

Top Category by
Listing Count

\$2.36M

AI 30-Day Revenue
(Highest of 29)

29

Categories
Covered

30-Day Revenue by Category (\$K)



AI generates
1.7x more
revenue than
#2 SaaS

Why AI? The \$540B Opportunity

The fastest-growing technology market in history



\$540B

Global AI market
size in 2026



30.6%

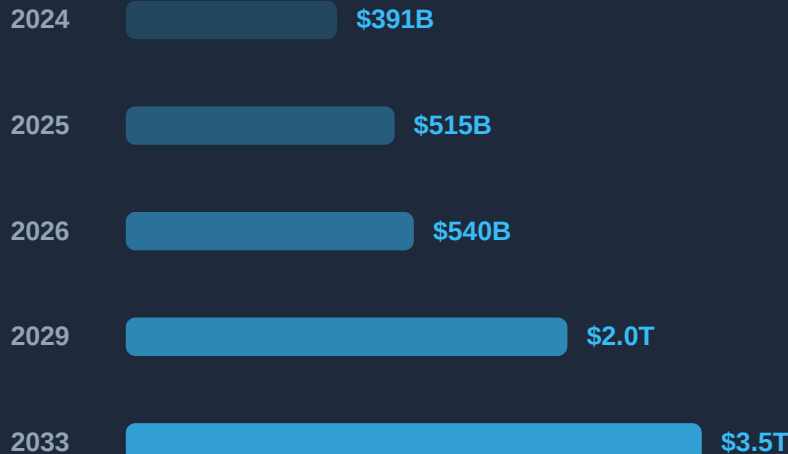
CAGR through
2033



88%

Organizations now
use AI

AI Market Growth Path



DAU/MAU: The AI Engagement Story

AI products show unprecedented user engagement and stickiness across categories

ChatGPT

DAU

210M

MAU

1B+

DAU/MAU 21%

Crossed 1B MAU in
Jun 2026. 900M WAU.
\$10B ARR.

Cursor

DAU

1M+

MAU

~5M

DAU/MAU ~20%

Fastest SaaS ever.
\$4B ARR in 31 months.
64% of Fortune 500.

Perplexity

DAU

~3M

MAU

30M

DAU/MAU ~10%

\$18B valuation.
780M queries/month.
80M+ app downloads.

Industry benchmark: 20%+ DAU/MAU is considered strong engagement for SaaS products

Standout Startup

Cursor by Anysphere

The fastest-growing SaaS company of all time

\$4B

ARR by May 2026

\$60B

Valuation
(SpaceX acquisition)

1M+

Daily Active Users

64%

Fortune 500
Penetration

Founded 2022 by 4 MIT students | 300 employees | \$13M+ revenue per employee

Cursor: \$0 to \$4B in 31 Months

Revenue doubling every two months — the steepest growth curve in SaaS history

Oct 2023



\$1M ARR

Jun 2025



\$500M ARR

Nov 2025



\$1B ARR

Feb 2026



\$2B ARR

May 2026



\$4B ARR

For comparison: Wiz took 4 years to reach \$500M ARR. Cursor did it in 20 months.

Why Cursor Is Poised for Explosive Growth

1

Product-Led Flywheel

- Individual devs adopt free tier
- Teams upgrade for collaboration
- Enterprise deals follow organically
- 65% revenue now from enterprise

2

Massive TAM

- 180M+ developers globally
- AI coding tools: \$12.8B market
- 90% of devs use AI tools daily
- >50% of code is AI-generated

3

Capital Efficiency

- \$13M+ revenue per employee
- Only 300-person team
- Gross-margin profitable (Apr '26)
- Both NVIDIA & Google invested

The Data Is Clear

01

AI dominates TrustMRR — highest listings, highest revenue, highest growth

02

DAU/MAU metrics confirm: AI products have unprecedented user stickiness

03

Cursor proves the thesis: \$0 to \$4B ARR in 31 months with only 300 people

Sources: TrustMRR Dataset (Frozen 30 Jul 2026), Grand View Research, TechCrunch, Bloomberg, Sacra, Stanford AI Index 2026